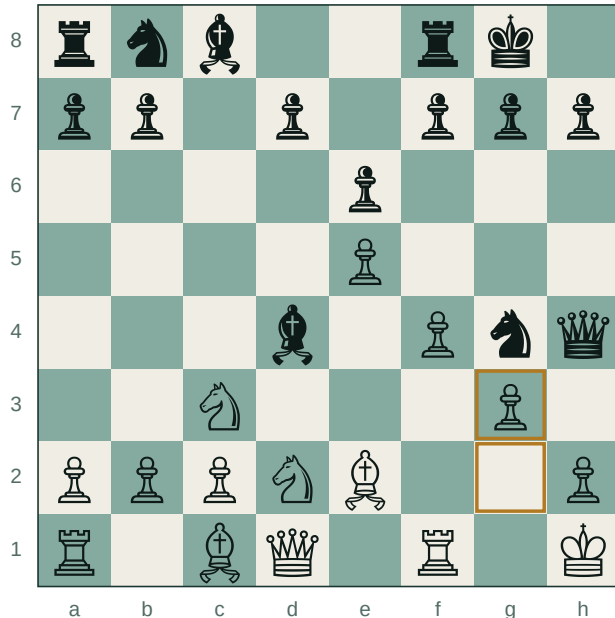


# Kingside attacks: Black, move 12

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 12.g3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 12...Qxh2#

**12...Qxh2#** Mate: queen on h2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

### CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

### HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: pawn on h2.